

ChatGPT said:



It looks like you've uploaded an image of a research methodology exam paper from the University of Punjab. Here's a quick breakdown of the questions that seem to be asked:

Question 1 (Short Questions):

1. Differentiate mediation and moderation.
2. Research methods vs. research methodology.
3. Differentiate mediation and moderation (repeated from part i).
4. Plagiarism.
5. Historical research.

Question 2:

- What is research design? Explain the steps involved in research design of descriptive research studies.

Question 3:

- Write a research proposal on any current economic issue related to the Pakistan economy.

Question 4:

- Define research process. Explain the different steps involved in carrying out the research process.

Would you like help answering any of these specific questions? Let me know which ones you'd like assistance with!



You said:

Answer all these questions



ChatGPT said:



Here are answers to each of the questions in the exam:

Q1. Answer the following short questions (5x6 = 30)

i. Differentiate mediation and moderation

- **Mediation** explains *how* or *why* an independent variable (IV) influences a dependent variable (DV) through a third variable (mediator). It focuses on the process or mechanism behind the relationship.
- **Moderation** explains *when* or *for whom* the relationship between the IV and DV changes based on the level of a third variable (moderator). It focuses on the conditions that influence the strength or direction of the relationship.

ii. Research methods vs. Research methodology

- **Research Methods** refer to the specific techniques or procedures used to gather and analyze data in research (e.g., surveys, experiments, observations). These are the practical tools for conducting research.
- **Research Methodology** is the theoretical framework that guides how research is designed and conducted. It includes the philosophical approach (e.g., qualitative vs. quantitative), the methods selected, and the rationale behind choosing those methods. It is broader than research methods and concerns the overall research process.

iii. Differentiate mediation and moderation

- This question repeats the first one, so the same answer applies:
 - **Mediation** explains *how* or *why* the IV influences the DV through a mediator.
 - **Moderation** examines *when* or *under what conditions* the IV affects the DV differently based on a moderator.

iv. Plagiarism

- **Plagiarism** is the act of using someone else's work, ideas, or words without proper attribution or permission. It is considered academic dishonesty and intellectual theft. Plagiarism can include copying text, paraphrasing without credit, or presenting another person's research as your own. Academic institutions and publications take plagiarism seriously and often impose strict penalties, including failing grades or disqualification.

v. Historical research

- **Historical research** involves studying past events, societies, or people to understand the causes, development, and effects of historical phenomena. This method often uses primary sources like documents, records, or artifacts to reconstruct historical events and interpret them in their historical context. Historical research aims to provide insights into how past experiences shape current knowledge, practices, and institutions.

Q2. What is research design? Explain the steps involved in research design of descriptive research studies. (10 marks)

Research Design:

- **Research design** is a detailed plan or blueprint for how to conduct a research study. It outlines the methods and procedures for collecting and analyzing data to answer research questions. It ensures that the study is organized and structured in a way that yields valid, reliable, and objective results.

Steps in Descriptive Research Design:

Descriptive research focuses on accurately describing the characteristics of a phenomenon or population without manipulating variables. The steps involved are:

1. **Identifying the Research Problem:** Clearly define the research question or hypothesis you want to explore or answer. Descriptive research typically focuses on *what* rather than *why*.
2. **Selecting the Population or Sample:** Determine the group or sample to study. In descriptive studies, researchers often focus on large samples to generalize findings.
3. **Data Collection Method:** Choose appropriate tools for data collection, such as surveys, interviews, or observational techniques. These tools should be designed to gather data that accurately describe the variables of interest.
4. **Designing the Survey or Instrument:** In descriptive research, surveys or observation checklists are common. Develop the instrument (questionnaire or observation guide) to collect the relevant information.
5. **Data Collection:** Conduct the data collection process, ensuring that the selected sample is appropriately surveyed or observed. In descriptive research, non-experimental methods are used.
6. **Data Analysis:** Analyze the data using descriptive statistics such as frequencies, percentages, and averages. Visual representation of data (e.g., tables, charts) is often used to summarize and interpret findings.

7. **Reporting Results:** Present the findings in a structured manner, explaining the data trends and providing descriptions of the phenomena being studied.

Q3. Write a research proposal on any **current economic issue** related to the Pakistan economy. (10 marks)

Research Proposal: Impact of Inflation on Household Purchasing Power in Pakistan

Introduction:

Inflation is a critical economic issue affecting the purchasing power of households across Pakistan. Over the past few years, the inflation rate in Pakistan has surged, leading to higher costs of goods and services. This study aims to explore the impact of inflation on the daily lives and purchasing decisions of Pakistani households, particularly middle- and lower-income families.

Research Problem:

How does inflation affect household purchasing power, particularly in urban areas, and what coping strategies are families adopting?

Research Objectives:

1. To assess the level of inflation over the past five years in Pakistan.
2. To analyze the impact of inflation on the purchasing power of households in different income brackets.
3. To examine coping mechanisms used by households to deal with rising prices.

Methodology:

- **Research Design:** Descriptive study.
- **Sample:** 300 households from major urban cities like Karachi, Lahore, and Islamabad.
- **Data Collection:** A structured questionnaire focusing on household income, expenses, and coping mechanisms due to inflation.
- **Data Analysis:** Descriptive statistics and correlation analysis to explore the relationship between inflation and purchasing power.

Expected Outcome:

This study will provide insights into how inflation affects the economic behavior of Pakistani households and will offer recommendations to policymakers on addressing inflationary pressure.

Q4. Define research process. Explain the different steps involved in carrying out the research process. (10 marks)

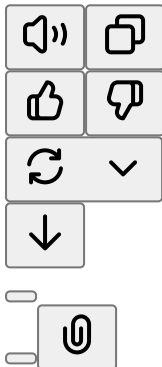
Research Process:

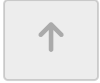
The **research process** is a systematic, organized series of steps used to investigate a problem, gather information, analyze data, and arrive at conclusions. It ensures that research is structured, replicable, and valid.

Steps in the Research Process:

1. **Identifying the Research Problem:** The first step is to clearly define the problem or topic that needs investigation. This includes formulating a research question or hypothesis.
2. **Review of Literature:** Conduct a thorough review of existing studies, theories, and data to gain a deeper understanding of the research topic and to identify gaps in the literature.
3. **Formulating Hypothesis:** If the research is hypothesis-driven, formulate a clear and testable hypothesis based on the literature review.
4. **Choosing Research Design:** Select an appropriate research design (e.g., experimental, descriptive, qualitative) based on the research objectives and questions.
5. **Data Collection:** Gather data using appropriate methods, such as surveys, experiments, or interviews. The choice of data collection method depends on the nature of the research.
6. **Data Analysis:** Analyze the collected data using statistical tools or qualitative techniques. This step involves identifying trends, patterns, or relationships in the data.
7. **Interpretation of Results:** Interpret the results in the context of the research question. This may involve comparing the findings to previous studies or theoretical frameworks.
8. **Report Writing:** Present the findings in a clear, logical, and organized manner. This step includes writing the research report, thesis, or paper and sharing it with others through publication or presentation.
9. **Conclusion and Recommendations:** Based on the findings, draw conclusions about the research question or hypothesis and suggest possible actions, solutions, or areas for further study.

These answers cover the questions comprehensively. Let me know if you need further clarification on any point!





ChatGPT can make mistakes. Check important info.

